

Monsoon Semester, 2020, Faculty of Architecture, CEPT University

Code	AR3017	Course	Realizing Nollis Dream: Embedding Architecture in the City		
Typology	Studio	Credits	14	GPA/NonGPA	GPA

Long Description :

Set of 12 copper engraved plans of Rome created by Italian architect and surveyor Giambattista Nolli in 1748 holds a great significance for architects, urbanists, historians and scholars. Apart from the classic 'figure-ground' representation revealing spatial and topographic structure of the city, Nolli's map shows enclosed colonnades and insides of civic buildings like churches, Pantheon as open collective/public spaces. Presenting dialectical relationships between buildings and their milieu, Nolli's representation also counters a tendency to see buildings as isolated objects outside the very context that give them life and meaning. In last few decades, civic and infrastructural projects constitute a big part of urban development in Indian cities. Though intentions of these projects are noble, their architectural approaches are singular and limited. Often they do not respond to the immediate physical and social context and end up becoming inaccessible parts of the city. Instead of exploiting potential of locational assets as prime collective/public spaces, these projects are reduced to set of buildings with homogeneous activities. Taking inspiration from Nolli's map, this studio aims to develop a conceptual and critical approach to architectural design where buildings are not seen not as isolated events, but that are deeply and intrinsically embedded in the fabric of the city. Objective of this studio is to architecturally reinterpret existing types of civic buildings/infrastructure in cities, well integrated with its immediate and broad urban context. Based on strong contextual awareness along with a need to relate buildings to individual users as well as collective needs, studio will investigate and explore various programmatic, spatial and architectural alternatives which will make it more accessible and inclusive in character. Links to previous studios... <https://portfolio.cept.ac.in/2020/S/fa/realizing-nollis-dream-embedding-architecture-in-the-city-ar3017-spring-2020>
<https://portfolio.cept.ac.in/archive/a-public-affair-rethinking-a-fly-over/>
<https://portfolio.cept.ac.in/archive/studio-8/>

Learning Outcomes :

After completing the Courses, the student will be able to :

- Analyse a building type and urban context
- Build architectural position and develop a vision of an urban collective/public place based on analysis and relevant theories
- Develop programmatic and spatial strategies for collective/public in sync with activities in given building type and its urban context
- Visualize and Design a building type embedded in their urban context through collective/public spaces

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Weekly Plan & Assessment :

Weeks	Exercise Description
Week 1	Exercise 1: Testing the Boundaries Imagine a new role of the boundary of public institutions as a collective space for activities which are not accounted during its conception but are vital to its functioning and its link to the city.
Week 2	Exercise 2: Reading Public Spaces and the City Read urban public spaces and their relationship with the city through vast body of literature and theoretical lens in order to understand their workings.
Week 3	Exercise 3: Decoding architectural Typology Unravel various aspects of a building type through systematic formal and operational analysis in order to understand its architectural functioning vis a vis its urban context.
Week 4	Exercise 4: Making sense of Site & Context Assimilate morphological, historical, environmental data and socio-political data and indices of the site and to situate it in the larger context of the city.
Week 5	Exercise 5: Dreaming Place in City Correlate the readings/references with findings from previous exercises to develop a narrative vision/thesis of a collective urban place for selected building type elaborating on the role of architectural setting as a stage for urban activities.
Week 6	Exercise 6: Programming for Collective/Public Based on previous analysis and narrative visions, develop program brief for collective/public activities in building type with their specific requirements, area statements, proximities, connections, etc.
Week 7	Exercise 7: Spatial Strategies Develop Spatial Strategies to organize activities to fulfil the above programmatic requirements and build connections with its immediate and boarder context
Week 8	Mid semester reviews
Week 9	Exercise 8: Design Organization Design and organize spaces for activities and connections in the building and its surrounding based on spatial strategies.
Week 10	Exercise 8: Design Organization
Week 11	Exercise 7: Design Development & Resolution Based on organization, develop an architectural language integrating various aspects of design such as structure, envelope, movement, fenestrations, etc.
Week 12	Exercise 7: Design Development & Resolution
Week 13	Exercise 7: Design Development & Resolution
Week 14	Exercise 7: Design Development & Resolution

Week 15	Presentation preparations
Week 16	Juries

Monsoon Semester, 2020, Faculty of Architecture, CEPT University

Code	AR3601	Course	Research Methods		
Typology	Courses	Credits	2	GPA/NonGPA	GPA

Long Description :

The Research Methods course aims to firstly enable students to comprehend the need and importance of the activity of research. Secondly, it shall help them to determine their area of interest be it toward producing a theoretical document or toward furthering a design project. The pertinence of research for the practice of architecture shall be specifically stressed here as general perception comprehends research to be only for the purpose of theory. Hence, the focus is not so much upon the theory of conducting research as is upon a practical approach whereby students are continuously in the process of producing draft upon draft of a proposal as they hone it step by step with insights gained in each session. Next, students shall be enabled to find out and state a topic regarding which they wish to test a hypothesis, record observations and/or analyze them. This would be followed by an intensive literature review exercise that shall focus on methods of choosing and finalizing to applicable texts, extract and analyze information from each and make notes of images/text that shall be referred to in the proposal. Finally, the course aims at a specific outcome, namely a research proposal, various formal components of which shall be brought to discussion in class. Students shall be expected to present a structured proposal, the categories of which such as —Aim, Objective, Hypothesis, Research Question, Framework of Analysis—would be clearly stated, along with a Project Brief. This would be a process comprising of three drafts at the least, each critiqued by the instructor and the TA.

Learning Outcomes :

After completing the Courses, the student will be able to :

- Upon successful completion of the course, students shall be able to - Comprehend the need and importance of research
- - Identify an area that interests them and sharpen their focus with respect to a topic
- - Identify Readings pertinent to their area of interest and evolve a strategy for perusal, recording information of interest, and text/images to be referred to
- - Critique research proposals and self-critique their drafts
- - Write and present a research proposal with all its formal components, in accordance with the APA referencing system and a detailed Reference list again in accordance with this system.

Monsoon Semester, 2020, Faculty of Architecture, CEPT University

Code	AR2718	Course	Making of a Forest City		
Typology	Courses	Credits	2	GPA/NonGPA	GPA

Long Description :

MAKING OF A FOREST CITY What is a forest system? Should we think of a forest and city together? The city is an idea constructed on the separation of man and nature, based on the belief that the human is above and beyond all natural systems. It is the greatest celebration of the 'man-made'. The forest is based on diversity and inclusiveness but that inclusiveness is governed by the natural law of the survival of the fittest. Can we imagine these two diverse systems coming together to form an all-together 'other' way of coexistence? A dual tone system. Keeping the focus on Ahmedabad, the speculative nature of the course would take us down a rabbit hole to imagine alternate city systems which are based in the forest city thinking and also provide wider solutions to individual urban concerns. This proposition of the alternate is based in our knowledge of today while looking at the need of tomorrow. Excepting issues in our consumption cycles and imagining possible solutions. The need is immediate and so the speculation would also be about the immediate future and proposing possible remedies.

Learning Outcomes :

After completing the Courses, the student will be able to :

- Individual articulation of a forest city and urban concerns emerging out of positions on sustainability and cohabitation.
- Visualisation of proposed alternate city systems.
- Compositing and designing the articulation and visualisation into a book.

Monsoon Semester, 2020, Faculty of Architecture, CEPT University

Code	AR3702	Course	POETRUSIC		
Typology	Courses	Credits	2	GPA/NonGPA	GPA

Long Description :

POETRUSIC aims to introduce students to the world of Poetry in four languages: English, Hindi, Urdu and Sanskrit. Each session shall be dedicated to one language; a language shall have a total of three slots in the semester. Works of two or three poets from the language shall be brought to class. The instructor shall read and discuss the pieces with the students and shall enumerate upon the socio-cultural context of the poet, poetic devices, rhyme and meter, and the meanings among other things. A detailed framework of Poetry Appreciation shall be evolved over the course of the semester through which the aesthetic of each piece of poetry shall be discerned. This is important to impart structure to the exercise which otherwise seems to get lost in likes and dislikes based on whims. The course aims to point out the usual, judgmental nature of critiques and ways in which they need to be made analytical, differentiated and detailed. Assignments shall comprise of analysis of pieces of poetry, at times consisting a single piece and at times comparative. The aforementioned framework shall be applied to this exercise of analysis. A mother tongue poetry session shall be organised where students will be expected to bring a piece or two from the corpus of poetry in their mother tongue. They shall explain it to class through a presentation.

Learning Outcomes :

After completing the Courses, the student will be able to :

- Upon successful completion of the course students shall be able to: name and quote at least three poets from the lingual domains of English, Hindi, Urdu and Sanskrit and one or more from their respective mother tongues.
- recognize poetic pleasure in word, sense and sound (meter, rhyme, rhythm).
- examine a piece of poetry with a structured framework at hand that they are exposed to within the course and thereby relate to the piece in recognizing its ipseity, difference from and similarity to other pieces. Thus, they shall be enabled to classify, interpret, compare and contrast pieces based on respective thematic, the poet and the times, lingual usage, genre, sound patterns, metaphor, imagery etc.
- analyze pieces of poetry in categorizing them vis a vis the categories in the framework and thereby appreciate, criticize and evaluate the Poesis in each piece.
- assess their concept of 'aesthetics' that is already evolving in their intangible in the larger context of the design education they are receiving in learning from the art of Poesis.

Spring Semester, 2021, Faculty of Architecture, CEPT University

Code	AR3032	Course	Urban Housing as a Product of Types, Density & Systems		
Typology	Studio	Credits	14	GPA/NonGPA	GPA

Long Description :

As per the 2011 Census more than 30% of the Indian population now lives in cities. This figure is expected to reach upto 50% by the year 2030. With the ever increasing rate of urbanisation, there has also been a steady growth of slums. At this juncture, around 20% of the Indian urban population lives in slums. Affordable housing, which caters to the needs of EWS and LIG sections, needs maximum attention, as right-to-shelter is one of the fundamental human rights. Housing in general, and urban housing in particular, demands sensitivity from the architect towards basic human values. These values are rooted, primarily, in three key aspects around which societies are organised: the socio-cultural aspects, the topographical aspects and the material-technological aspects. The house-form emerges, first by responding to the intangible needs attached with the socio-cultural aspects; and the tangible aspects related to the material, technology and topography help in materialising the final product. The socio-cultural aspects that govern housing form will be addressed by questioning conventional typologies in the form of BHK. Careful examination of the user group and the activity patterns give rise to alternative typologies and clusters that could cater to multiple needs of families and communities as they grow. Students will arrive at this understanding by looking at housing case-studies and various other reference materials. The topographical aspects are best represented by the growing relevance of sustainable approach to built environments. Performance based design with aspects of thermal comfort will be at the forefront in this domain. The technological aspects are rooted in the issues related with choice of materials and choice of appropriate technology. Complete in-situ, mix of in-situ and pre-cast/pre-fab, or compete pre-cast/pre-fab, are broadly speaking the directions in which students can explore possibilities of generating systems that can be used in a given urban context, across various sites. In this design studio, students will address the issue of affordable urban housing by responding to the three criteria mentioned above. The idea here is to look at housing as a product, as a system, much in the sense of vernacular architecture.

Learning Outcomes :

After completing the Courses, the student will be able to :

- Students will learn the design process of 'Matrix', in order to take a pragmatic approach to the problem of Affordable Urban Housing
- Students will learn 'Systems' based approach to design, in order to effectively cater to the needs of mass-scale of affordable urban housing.

Weekly Plan & Assessment :

Weeks	Exercise Description
Week 1	Understanding issues related with 'Urban Housing': (Lectures & Seminar) 1) Lectures 2) Theoretical Readings 3) Seminar 4) Introduction of Program and the concept of 'Matrix': an Idea bank in the form of table
Week 2	Housing Types: 1) Study of 'House Types': Factors that give birth to Types 2) Incorporate ideas in the 'Matrix'
Week 3	Density/Clusters: 1) Study of 'Clusters': strategies that generate density 2) Incorporate ideas/strategies in the 'Matrix'
Week 4	Systems: 1) Understanding the role of various 'systems' associated with Housing Production/Making/Language / or / Understanding various factors that can generate 'systems' associated with Housing production/Making/Language (Factors such as: Climate, Material, Structure, Technique of Construction, Dimensional Co-ordination) 2) Incorporate ideas/strategies in the 'Matrix'
Week 5	Same as Week-4
Week 6	Finalising the Matrix and Exploring Various Possible combinations: 1) Exploring combination of ideas from the 'Matrix' 2) Physical and digital models
Week 7	Evolving the 'System'-1: 1) Breaking the system at various scales: unit level (spatial combinations), Cluster level, Elements and rules of combining them
Week 8	Mid-Semester Jury Presentation: 1) Process 2) Drawings 3) Models
Week 9	Evolving the 'System'-2: 1) Breaking the system at various scales: unit level (spatial combinations), Cluster level, Elements and rules of combining them 2) Further detailing and fine-tuning
Week 10	Application-1: 1) Apply the system on Site-1 2) Identify issues/problems
Week 11	Application-2: 1) Apply the system on Site-2 2) Identify issues/problems
Week 12	Application-3: 1) Apply the system on Site-3 2) Identify issues/problems
Week 13	Finalising the 'System': 1) Based on the issues/problems identified by application on three different sites, make changes in the 'System' and come up with final version.
Week 14	Demonstration of the 'System': 1) Apply the final 'System' on any one of the site and prepare final design.
Week 15	Final Jury Presentation: 1) Process 2) Drawings 3) Models

Week 16	Same as Week-15
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Spring Semester, 2021, Faculty of Architecture, CEPT University

Code	AR3600	Course	Professional Practice		
Typology	Courses	Credits	2	GPA/NonGPA	GPA

Long Description :

This course aims to develop a basic understanding of the scope of professional practice based on a broad overview of the various elements involved in a design practice. It will discuss the role of the architect, the management and operation of a design practice along with critical issues of professional ethics. The course will emphasise on the following: 1. Develop a basic understanding of the scope of professional practice 2. Understand the building procurement process. 3. Acquired knowledge and skills sufficient for early stages of directed activity in an existing design practice, including the ability to design and document projects. 4. Developed intellectual and creative approaches and adaptability to form a basis for continued learning and development throughout professional life. 5. Communicating – the communication and documentation of designs for presentation to clients and other stakeholders, and for construction; the preparation of professional reports. 6. Managing – the management and operation of a design practice. 7. Professional ethics, environmental sustainability, cultural, social, economic responsibilities of the design professions. 8. The recognition of the contribution of the design professions to society. In this course, participants will gain insights into Professional Practice in domains related to built environment, and opportunities and possibilities as well as larger issues related to theory and practices in the field. Going through this course will not tell you what is right for you, but it will help you decide. THIS COURSE WILL BE OFFERED AS A 10 DAY WORKSHOP DURING MAY 2021

Learning Outcomes :

After completing the Courses, the student will be able to :

- The students should have an overview of the various components of a professional practice, and understand their role as professionals, in particular with reference to the ethics and code of conduct. The students will acquire knowledge and skills sufficient for early stages of directed activity in an existing practice or be able to initiate a practice of their own. The students will be exposed to the basics of legalities of contracts.

Spring Semester, 2021, Faculty of Architecture, CEPT University

Code	AR2714	Course	Notions of Domesticity		
Typology	Courses	Credits	2	GPA/NonGPA	NonGPA

Long Description :

We all have an intimate relationship with the houses we live in. The house designs subconsciously govern many of our behaviour patterns. Yet we know very little about their genesis. How did we reach a stage where houses are primarily identified as 2/3/4 bhk? Why do most people buy a house rather than get one built? This course opens up discussions about the design of houses from multiple perspectives- social [e.g. family as the standard unit, family life cycle, gender], material [e.g. notions of high vs. low maintenance], regulatory [e.g. building bye-laws, public health], construction [standardization] to name a few. This is done through selected readings in class. Each student will be expected to present a summary and reflection of the selected reading and discuss the same in the class. The course will conclude with a comparative study of a student's own house with another apartment from the perspective of meaning and activity. This will form the basis of concluding discussions on the changing notions of domesticity. On completion of this course students will be able to go beyond formal and organizational analysis of houses and examine them in relation to larger sociological concepts.

Learning Outcomes :

After completing the Courses, the student will be able to :

- Analyse house designs from multiple perspectives [social, cultural, material, and regulatory]

Weekly Plan & Assessment :

Weeks	Exercise Description
Week 1	Did you know? a discussion of interesting and lesser known aspects of the houses that we live in through videos and texts
Week 2	defining the home and its relation with other building types
Week 3	regulating the home or why cant I build what I want?
Week 4	who is it for? questions of family, life cycle, gender
Week 5	housing standards and standardization
Week 6	meaning of dwelling features
Week 7	home and privacy
Week 8	comparing houses across cultures and time zones
Week 9	notions of domesticity discussion based on student assignments
Week 10	notions of domesticity discussion based on student assignments
Week 11	notions of domesticity discussion based on student assignments
Week 12	notions of domesticity discussion based on student assignments